

On the other hand, VirtualBox's seamless mode, unlike VMware Workstation's Unity, fails to provide a visual difference on screen between the guest operating system and host operating system's application windows. In a scenario when you have same operating system as your guest as well as host (say a Ubuntu guest on a Ubuntu host) or visually similar ones (such as a Windows Vista guest on a Windows 7 host or a Fedora 16 guest on a openSUSE 12.1 host), it will easily get confusing when switching between guest and host application windows. Moreover, seamless mode is for use only when you have to switch between guest and host application windows too often. To avoid confusion at such times, you should only keep those application windows from both guest and the host operating system visible between which you need to switch frequently and you should be fine. Despite the few shortcomings of VirtualBox's seamless mode, it's a great feature (more so, when you look at the price – it's free).

- ▶ **Snapshots:** Just like VMware Workstation, VirtualBox also facilitates snapshots and have almost the same features as VMware Workstation; like having the ability to take multiple snapshots, ability to take a snapshot while the machine is running and reverting back to a snapshot of your choice in case you want to go back in time. In addition to this, when you're trying to go back to a snapshot, VirtualBox will humbly ask you to take a snapshot of the present state. This is to make sure that in case you've done some important changes to the virtual machine since you last took a snapshot, those changes don't get lost. Although asking the user to take a new snapshot of the current state before reverting to a previous one is too small a feature, it's helpful. More so, when VirtualBox doesn't have anything like VMware Workstation's AutoProtect feature.

We're sure that there's not much more one would ask from VirtualBox if you're a general desktop user looking for some experimentation and minor work inside a different operating system than the one installed on your computer. VirtualBox has no support for guest isolation, autologon, movie recording (although you can take a screenshot) or VM encryption but that should be fine with any average user wanting to try out virtualization in an easy-to-use way without having to pay anything. A lot of development work is in progress on VirtualBox's part and it's expected to provide better support for 3D acceleration and AERO support in the next major release, though nothing can be guaranteed.